ASSETPLUS

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The salaried investor with a windfall

Karthik, 36: the story, the conversation, and the numbers to show



In short: Karthik has ₹25 lakh from a bonus and vested ESOPs, mostly in one stock. A hybrid SIF can take part of it while he spreads the rest into equity funds; in March 2026 it fell 1.9% against 11.3% for the Nifty.



Karthik, 36

Tech professional · 30% tax slab · illustrative story

Karthik just received ₹25 lakh from a bonus and an ESOP sale. Another ₹18 lakh still sits in his employer's shares. He runs equity SIPs, but putting ₹25 lakh into shares at once, after a falling year, makes him nervous.

"What if I invest everything and the market falls next month?"

The conversation

PARTNER
How much of your wealth is in your employer's shares?

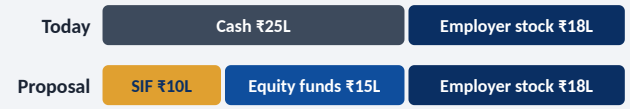
CLIENT
Too much, honestly.

PARTNER
Put ₹10 lakh in a hybrid SIF and move the rest into equity funds over 6 to 12 months.

CLIENT
Why the SIF?

PARTNER
It holds steadier while you wait. In March 2026 it lost about ₹19,000 on ₹10 lakh; the Nifty lost ₹1.13 lakh.

Before and after ₹ lakh



Why a SIF may fit

- Holds the lump sum while equity is added in steps
- Lower swings than equity while he waits
- Balances a portfolio heavy in one employer's shares

Numbers to show % return; after tax for a 30% slab investor

	Last 12 months	After tax (30% slab)	March 2026 (Nifty −11.3%)
Nifty 50 (incl. dividends)	**−11.24%**	No tax (a loss)	**−11.30%**
Balanced advantage funds	**−4.34%**	No tax (a loss)	**−6.69%**
Hybrid SIF, middle fund	**7.51%**	**6.01% or 5.26%**	**−1.92%**

Objections you will hear

They say	You can say
"I want full equity growth."	His SIPs already give that. The SIF is for the lump sum he is unsure about.
"My company stock will keep rising."	Perhaps; but his job and savings depend on one company. Spreading is the point.
"Tax on ESOPs is already high."	The SIF is taxed only when he sells; ESOP tax is separate and already paid on vesting.

Not suitable if

- Needs the money for a home within a year
- Wants only pure equity
- Has no emergency fund yet

Next steps on AssetPlus

- Plan the ESOP sale with his tax adviser
- Set up the SIF and an equity transfer plan
- Review after the next vesting

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